

Richard Rogers

British structural expressionist Richard Rogers (b.1933) began his career exploring ideas about prefabrication; his concept of the 'zip up' house used standardized components to create energy-efficient buildings. However, he is acclaimed today for his innovative designs, including the Pompidou Centre in Paris (designed with Renzo Piano) and the Lloyd's Building (1978–86, opposite) in London, both examples of 'inside out'. The European Court of Human Rights in Strasbourg features two huge steel drums accessed through a glass-walled atrium.

His Millennium Dome (1999) in London, made of coated glass fibre and supported by 100-metre (328-ft) yellow towers, formed the core of a plan to regenerate part of the city, while his Senedd, the National Assembly for Wales in Cardiff (built 2001–6), has a glass façade, steel roof and wooden ceiling, and was designed to be sustainable. It was not to be an 'insular, closed edifice', he said, but 'a transparent envelope, looking outwards to Cardiff Bay and beyond'.

